About the Cognitive Reasoning Integrity Standard (CRIS)

Canonical Definition

Cognitive Reasoning Integrity Standard (CRIS) defines the structural conditions under which reasoning processes, inference chains, logical transitions, conclusion formation, assumption management, evidence utilization, and cognitive justification remain traceable, coherent, reconstructable, governance-valid, and operationally reliable across human, agent, and multi-agent cognition environments.

Reasoning is the process through which meaning becomes conclusions.

CRIS governs the integrity of that transformation.

What This Standard Is

CRIS is a parent standard defining the governance architecture for cognitive reasoning integrity.

It governs:

- inference integrity
- assumption governance
- evidence-based reasoning
- logical consistency
- conclusion validity
- reasoning traceability
- cognition justification
- reasoning reliability
- reasoning governance

CRIS establishes the conditions under which cognition remains capable of producing valid conclusions from valid meaning.

What This Standard Is Not

CRIS is not:

- a decision engine
- a machine-learning model
- a logic programming language
- a theorem-proving system
- a prediction framework
- an analytics platform
- a decision-support application

CRIS does not govern conclusions themselves.

CRIS governs how conclusions are reached.

Why This Standard Exists

Every cognition system reasons.

Humans reason.

Agents reason.

Organizations reason.

Multi-agent systems reason.

Future autonomous environments will increasingly depend on reasoning to:

- make decisions
- assess evidence
- evaluate risk
- generate recommendations
- justify actions
- allocate resources
- predict outcomes
- coordinate operations

Most governance approaches focus on:

- outputs
- recommendations
- decisions
- performance

However, before any decision emerges, reasoning has already occurred.

A conclusion may appear correct.

A recommendation may appear useful.

A decision may appear successful.

Yet the reasoning process that produced it may be fundamentally invalid.

This creates a critical governance challenge.

CRIS exists because reasoning itself has become a governable space.

Core Insight

Correct conclusions do not automatically prove correct reasoning.
Reasoning integrity depends on whether inference, assumptions, evidence, logic, and justification remain valid throughout cognition.

Operational Architecture Space

CRIS defines the operational architecture space for:

- reasoning governance
- inference governance
- assumption governance
- evidence reasoning
- logical consistency governance
- conclusion formation governance
- cognition justification
- reasoning traceability
- reasoning validity

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This space exists because conclusions do not emerge directly from meaning.

Conclusions emerge through reasoning.

CRIS governs whether that process remains valid.

CRIS closes the governable space between meaning and conclusions.

Use Case 1 — Strategic Decision Intelligence System

Scenario

An enterprise intelligence environment analyzes information and generates
strategic recommendations affecting organizational decisions.

Application

CRIS governs inference quality, assumption visibility, evidence utilization,
and conclusion justification throughout the reasoning process.

Result

The organization gains stronger reasoning transparency, reduced conclusion risk,
and improved governance confidence.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous Planning Agent

Scenario

An autonomous agent evaluates multiple operational options
and generates plans for future execution.

Application

CRIS governs reasoning traceability, logical consistency, assumption management,
and evidence-supported conclusion formation.

Result

The environment gains stronger planning reliability, reduced reasoning drift,
and improved operational validity.

Architectural Position

Within the OOF system, CRIS belongs under:

AI & Interpretation

Cognitive Governance Intelligence Architecture (CLIA®)

CRIS serves as the parent standard governing reasoning.

It extends the CLIA® ecosystem into the governance of inference, assumptions,
evidence utilization, logical consistency, conclusion formation,
and cognitive justification.

CRIS provides the architecture space from which future reasoning-governance modules
may be derived.

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Closing Definition

Reasoning is the bridge between meaning and conclusions.
Cognitive reasoning remains valid only when inference, assumptions, evidence, logic,
and justification remain traceable, coherent, reconstructable,
and governance-valid throughout cognition.

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